

Spring 2026 NLP Final Project Rubric

Gene Louis Kim

1 Overall Final Project Grade Breakdown

The final stage of the final project's grading is broken down into two parts: (1) the final report and (2) the in-person presentation and QA. Given the amount of help that current LLMs can be in writing and analysis, the in-person presentation and QA will make up a substantial portion of the grade. Please come prepared to clearly and *briefly* describe your project and answer questions about it. See the table below for an overall breakdown. Below is a high-level breakdown of the project components and point allotment.

Project Components and Point Breakdown

Component	Points	Notes
Project Idea Proposal	25	Previously graded milestone
Project Check-in	10	Previously graded milestone
Final Presentation	30	Evaluated at the end of the project
Final Report	35	Evaluated at the end of the project
Total	100	

2 Final Presentation (30 points)

Due to the amount of help that current AI systems can provide in coding, writing, and analysis, the presentation and question answering portion of the grading is critical. Please note that the presentation is worth almost as much as the final report. **This project will have a *passing standard* for the final presentation. If I am not convinced of your understanding of the project details based on the presentation and QA, the final report score may also see a deduction.**

Presentation Rubric

Criterion	Points	Notes
Communicated clearly and effectively	/18	Clarity and quality of presentation
Delivery and ability to answer questions	/12	Demonstration of command of the work
Presentation Total	/30	

2.1 Final Presentation Format

The format will lean heavily on question answering. Please prepare a **5-minute** presentation stating your research question(s), key literature you build upon, main methods, and main results. Then we will have 4 minutes for 2-3 questions. *It is in your best interest not to go over the 5-minute presentation time. The QA is a key step for you to convince me that you understand your project.*

Final Report (35 points)

The final report should be of the quality of a technical report or a rough publication manuscript. There is no specific required format. If you are integrating your lab's work into this project, use whichever format is preferred in your lab. If you do not have a format in mind already, I would recommend using one of the major NLP conference paper formats. *These will require getting familiar with LaTeX and will likely take a bit longer to put together. But if you plan to turn this into an archival paper or publication, this would put you in the right direction.*

- Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL): <https://github.com/acl-org/acl-style-files/>
- Conference on Language Modeling (COLM): <https://github.com/COLM-org/Template/releases/tag/2026>

Report Rubric

Criterion	Points	Notes
Problem formulation	/5	Clear statement of the task, question, or objective
Connection to prior literature	/5	Appropriate background, citations, and positioning
Method or experimental design	/5	Soundness and clarity of approach
Evaluation setup and metrics	/5	Whether the evaluation can answer the project question
Results, analysis, and interpretation	/5	Depth of analysis beyond reporting raw numbers
Writing quality and organization	/5	Clarity, structure, formatting, and enough detail to follow the work
Demo code, data, & reproducibility	/5	Code/data + documentation to verify implementation
Final Report Total	/35	

2.2 Report Deliverables

For the report and associated demo code & data, please submit a zip file of a folder with the following structure.

- `report.pdf`: your project report
- `README`: instructions on running your demo code
- `*`: code & data associated with your project to document your work and allow me to verify your work

The demo does **not** need to cover everything you did in your report. This is meant to be a quick test for us to verify that you have a functional artifact associated with your project (e.g., running your evaluation on a small subset of data) and generating summary metrics.

Performance Level Guide

Here's a rough qualitative guide on how I will be grading each component.

Level	General Description
1. Excellent	Complete, technically strong, clearly communicated, and analytically thoughtful
2. Good	Solid overall with minor weaknesses in execution, clarity, or depth
3. Adequate	Meets minimum expectations but lacks depth, clarity, or strong analysis
4. Needs Improvement	Major gaps in method, evaluation, communication, or completeness
5. Incomplete	Missing critical component of graded aspect or submission missing entirely